Disciplinary Policy

Adopted March 5, 2025

The purpose underlying the discipline policy of the PVSSD and PVFD is to establish a consistent procedure for maintaining suitable behavior and a productive working environment. These procedures are directory in nature and minor variations of the processes set forth herein shall not affect the validity of any actions taken pursuant to this policy.

It is understood that PVSSD board members and PVFD officers and members are unpaid volunteers. As such, greater understanding is encouraged before disciplinary actions are taken. Safety is the number one priority and governing principle.

The need for disciplinary action may result from incidents related to safety, performance of duties, and personal conduct which may be detrimental to the PVSSD or PVFD. Disciplinary procedures shall consist of the following:

Pine Valley Fire Department

A. Written Reprimand
   A written reprimand is a formal warning given to a member for misconduct or failure to improve conduct which is documented in writing, dated and signed by the Fire Chief. A copy of the notice shall be given to the member who shall sign to acknowledge receipt. A copy shall be placed in the member's personnel file.
B. Probation
   As part of any disciplinary action, the Fire Chief may place any member on probation for any amount of time deemed necessary by the Fire Chief. The action will be documented in writing, dated and signed by the Fire Chief. A copy of the notice shall be given to the member who shall sign to acknowledge receipt. A copy shall be placed in the member's personnel file. Once the probationary time frame is completed without incident, the member may be released from probation with that information placed in the member's personnel file. If the member does not successfully complete the requirements set forth by the Fire Chief during his/her time of probation, further action may be taken up to and including dismissal from the department.
C. Dismissal from Department
   A dismissal is an involuntary termination of membership in the PVFD for disciplinary purposes. Members on probation may be dismissed during the probationary period at the discretion of the Fire Chief. Documentation of the dismissal shall be placed in the member's personnel file.

Pine Valley Special Service Board

A. Written Reprimand
   A writing reprimand is a formal warning given to a board member for misconduct or failure to improve conduct which is documented in writing, dated and signed by the Board Chair and Vice-Chair. A copy shall be given to the member.
B. Recommend Dismissal from Board
   Ongoing or egregious violations of this policy may cause the remaining board members to petition the Washington County commissioners to dismiss the offending board member from service.

Independent Contractors

Independent contractors are governed by the terms of their contracts.